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AFGHANISTAN: 20 Years of War

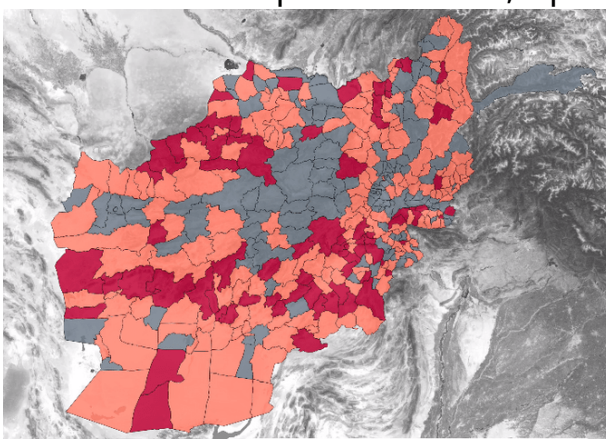
The United States invaded Afghanistan in the year of 2001 in response to the 9/11 attacks in USA, that killed 2977 Americans. It was the deadliest terrorist attacks in the history. The attacks were carried out by Al-Qaeda, a terrorist organization. The US very quickly identified Osama Bin Laden, the leader of Al Qaeda responsible for the attacks. At the time the Taliban, which was another radical Islamist group running Afghanistan, was protecting Bin Laden, and refused to hand him over to the US. After which US alongside NATO invoked article-5 of the NATO charter for the first time, where 60 countries would send in their troops to fight US' mission "Operation Enduring Freedom". That's where the invasion begins in late 2001.



COST OF WAR: Afghanistan



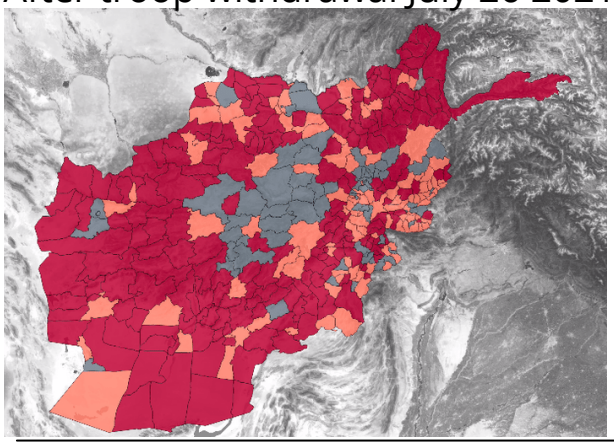
Before US Troop Withdrawal, April 17 2021



CONTESTED
AFGHAN GOVT.
TALIBAN CONTROL

Before the US troop withdrawal Taliban controlled around 75 of the districts, while the Afghan govt. controlled around 130 districts, with around 90 contested districts. But after the US troop withdrawal began especially after US handed over its Bagram Air Base, its major military hub to Afghan forces and left unannounced (almost like fleeing), that's when Taliban took over and started taking control of districts from government. Now Taliban claims to control over 85% of Afghanistan, including major border points for trade. In total Taliban has control over 220 districts while govt has around 70 only. Now Taliban is a radical Islamist terror group, which used to rule over Afghanistan, and during that time it imposed strict sharia and Islamic law in the country, which led to a lot of violence especially towards women. Afghan people were lashed for petty theft and women had to wear chador and burqa, upon showing even little skin women were lashed severely. Women and children were not allowed education. And now that the US has left the situation is only getting worse.

After troop withdrawal July 26 2021



USA



The US invaded Afghanistan for mainly 3 things, to demolish Al Qaeda and Taliban, to stop the use of Afghanistan as a terrorist base and reign in terror and of course to catch Osama Bin Laden. At the peak US has over 110,000 troops in Afghanistan in 2011, that's also when Osama Bin Laden was killed in an air strike in a compound in Abbottabad in Pakistan. After 20 years, its safe to say that America failed mostly. And now it has left Afghanistan to fend for itself, and that is what the overwhelming majority says. And it's true to certain good extent. In the 20 year war America spent **2 trillion USD+** and 2400+ US troops lost lives 241,000 people have been killed in the Afghanistan and Pakistan war zone since 2001. More than 71,000 of those killed have been civilians. The Zone has seen worst cases of human rights abuses and war crimes. War has exacerbated already grave situation in Afghanistan.

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